SF at Pune. But she kept her composure and knew that, given a choice, I would rather have stayed home with her and the kids, playing some board games and trying to see if the girls could catch me cheating (just to keep them alert), which they would with squeals of joy. Even now, they are always on the lookout for some sleight of hand that I might be perpetrating.

To make matters worse, I was found to have an 'abnormal ECG' during my routine annual medical. I'm no medical expert, but apparently, it was abnormal enough for the medical specialist at MH Meerut to directly call up the CO and advise him of my immediate hospitalization. I felt physically fine, having just cleared my battle physical efficiency tests (BPET), but mentally, I was in a state of shock. I insisted I was fine but the medical specialist, Col Karambiah, would have none of it. I told him I would just go home and return, but when he came to know I had come on my scooter, he declined even that request. That matters could be so serious came like a bolt from the blue and only added to the stress that Veena and I were under. Col Karambiah gave me some sound advice. He said, 'I know you'll be fine, but better get it checked up and cleared now, rather than later in life when it might be held against you.' From Meerut, I was referred to the Command Hospital, Lucknow, going there by train, accompanied by a nursing assistant to cater for any emergency en route, and put through a battery of tests by the cardiologist there, a Col Chawla, who was supposed to be as tough as nails. A stress thallium and stress MUGA revealed nothing wrong, but Col Chawla nevertheless downgraded me medically for a period of six months. This was a serious blow to my morale and I was quite down in the dumps, but being with Veena and the girls helped cheer me up. After the six months were over, it was back to the CH once again for a repeat of all the tests, to see if there were any changes or

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